

SK8 SECRET TRAILS NO. 1

The Cheadle Case

The Vanishing of 1926

MISSING

CASE FILE 001 / CHEADLE / EARLY ACCESS PUBLIC BETA

**Five case letters. Three extra side cases.
One final connection at Abney Hall.**

EARLY ACCESS PUBLIC BETA. The route and clue sightlines are still being tested. If anything is unclear or has changed, use the backup clue and tell us at the end.

YOUR MISSION

Follow the evidence through Cheadle. Five main clues give you case letters. Three side cases add extra evidence and two of their answers matter in the finale. Put the letters together, then use the hidden name to solve the final mystery at Abney Hall.



The useful, the local and the mildly nosy.

CASE FILE 001

Somebody Vanished

December 1926. Somebody disappeared. Their car was found abandoned the next morning and a nationwide search followed. When the missing person was eventually found, the story took an unexpected turn towards Cheadle.

Your job is not to explain the disappearance. That part is still debated. Your job is to uncover the Cheadle connection.

1926

MYSTERY
PEOPLE
PLACES
CLUES

WHAT YOU NEED

A pen or pencil. About 50-70 minutes.
A grown-up for road crossings.
Curiosity helps.



BE A
DETECTIVE!

ROUTE AT A GLANCE

STOP	LOOK FOR	AREA	
1	St Mary's Lychgate	Church Street	
2	Former Premier Cafe	3 High Street	
3	George & Dragon	High Street	
4	Manor House	Manchester Road	
5	Ockleston Memorial	Cheadle Green	
★ FINAL	Abney Hall	Abney Hall Park	

EXPLORE

LOOK

DISCOVER

SOLVE

BACKUP RULE

If a main clue is missing, unreadable or unsafe to inspect, use the emergency letter in the hint strip and carry on. Side cases are bonus evidence: skip one if it cannot be done safely. Do not cross a road just to prove a clue.



EVIDENCE 1

The gate that remembers

📍 St Mary's lychgate, Church Street



YOUR MISSION

Read the inscription on the wooden gateway.
Find the **year**, then find the **word** that explains why the gate was erected.

Year: _____

Key word: _____

EXTRACT

If the inscription says it was erected in **memory** of someone, take the first letter of **MEMORY**.



DISCOVER

Historic England records the lychgate as an **1883** memorial.
Its timber frame sits on a stone plinth and the gates retain old ironwork.

SIDE CASE 1

The porch number

Before leaving St Mary's, find the stone south porch. Historic England records it as dated **1634**. Add the four digits together: $1 + 6 + 3 + 4$. Keep the total for later.

Side-case number: _____

STUCK?

Look along the inscription on the gate itself.
Emergency letter: **M**.



St Mary's lychgate, Church Street

EVIDENCE 2

The cafe hiding in a shopfront

Former Premier Cafe, 3 High Street



LOOK HERE

Find the narrow strip of older glass immediately above the big ground-floor shop windows, beside the entrance. Ignore the modern pharmacy signs.

LOOK

Ignore the modern business signs. Look at the older glass above the shop windows.

Can you spot etched lines spreading out from a centre?



EXTRACT

The pattern is a **sunburst**, part of the building's 1930s Art Deco frontage. Take the first letter of **ART**.

A

DISCOVER



The building was remodelled in the mid-1930s. Historic England specifically records stylised sunburst etchings in the shopfront glass.



STUCK?

Look at the older decorative glass rather than the modern signs. If it cannot be seen safely or clearly, use emergency letter **A** and carry on.

CASE LETTERS: M A _ _ _





Where the carriages went

LOOK



Find the unusually wide entrance made for vehicles. Trace the top edge in the air with your hand. Is it curved, pointed or flat?

Shape: _____



EXTRACT

If you wrote **CURVED**, take its last letter.

D



DISCOVER



The listed building description records a carriage entry in the first bay with a segmental arch. It is a surviving clue to how the building once worked.



STUCK?

You are looking for an opening much wider than an ordinary doorway. Emergency letter: **D**.

SIDE CASE 2

The window above the arch

Look directly above the carriage entrance. The listed description calls the window there **tripartite**. How many main vertical parts can you make out?

Side-case number: _____



EVIDENCE 4

The house that steps forward

Manor House, Manchester Road

LOOK



Look high up at the front of the timber-framed house. Count the main upper sections that project forward towards you.

How many? _____

EXTRACT



Those projecting triangular ends are **GABLES**. Take the first letter.

G

DISCOVER



The Manor House is said to date from 1664. Historic England records two bays, each with a jettied gable above.

STUCK?

Look above the ground-floor windows. If the view is blocked or unclear, use emergency letter **G**.

CASE LETTERS:

M A D G _



CASE FILE 005

The doctor's eight-sided secret

Ockleston Memorial, Cheadle Green

WHO WAS OCKLESTON?

Robert Ockleston was a notable Cheadle doctor. Historic England records that he died in 1888 and that this memorial was erected in 1889. The octagonal trough is the clue you need.

1888 Ockleston died

1889 Memorial erected

YOUR CLUE

Find the old memorial with the large trough around its base. Count the sides.

Number of sides: _____

EXTRACT

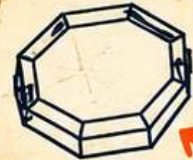
Write your number in words. If you found **EIGHT**, take its first letter.

E

Can you count all the sides?

DISCOVER

The memorial commemorates Cheadle doctor Robert Ockleston. Historic England records an octagonal trough and an 1889 memorial inscription.



An octagonal trough!

STUCK?

Walk around only where public space makes that safe. Emergency letter: **E**.

CASE LETTERS:

M A D G E

Now read the five letters as a name.

Your hidden name: _____

If you have **MADGE**, good. Madge is not the missing person. She is the person who unlocks the final part of the case.

NEXT MOVE

Head to **Abney Hall Park** using normal pedestrian routes and crossings. On the way, keep an eye out for the most over-the-top architectural detail you can see. Save it for the final photo challenge.

Who is Madge?



FINAL EVIDENCE

Who is Madge?



Explore the clues and discover the writer connected with Abney Hall...

 **Abney Hall, Abney Hall Park**

Find the public information about the famous writer connected with Abney Hall. Do not enter private or restricted areas.



USE THE NAME YOU FOUND

Your five letters are **MADGE**. Find out who Madge was, then complete the evidence below.

EVIDENCE



Madge's full name:



Her famous younger sister:

SIDE CASE 3

The family link

Find the single family-relationship word that connects Madge to Agatha Christie.



Relationship:

Emergency answer if the public information is unavailable: **SISTER**.



Do not turn the page until you have a name and a relationship.

If the public information is missing or unreadable, the mystery can still continue using the next page.



THE FINAL DEDUCTION

How long was she gone?

The missing person was **Agatha Christie**, Madge's younger sister. Your two number side cases now matter.



USE YOUR SIDE-CASE NUMBERS

St Mary's should have given you **14**. The George & Dragon should have given you **3**. Subtract the smaller number from the larger one.

$$14 - 3 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$$

DATE 1

3 DEC

HOW MANY DAYS PASSED?

DATE 2

14 DEC

Those two numbers echo the real dates. Christie left home on **3 December 1926** and was found in Harrogate on **14 December**.

Your answer: _____ days

If both routes gave you **11**, you have the last piece of the case.

CASE SOLVED

Agatha Christie was recognised in Harrogate after an eleven-day disappearance. Cheadle Civic Society records that her older sister Madge escorted her to Abney Hall to recover. The reason Christie disappeared remains unresolved.

Why Cheadle matters

You were not following the mystery to the place where Christie vanished. You were following it to the place where one extraordinary chapter of the story ended.

THE MISSING WRITER

AGATHA CHRISTIE

Left home: 3 Dec 1926

Recognised in Harrogate:

14 Dec 1926

11 DAYS

The National Archives records that she was recognised at the Swan Hydro hotel 11 days after leaving home.



CASE CLOSED

The Cheadle connection

MADGE + CHEADLE

Margaret 'Madge' Watts was Agatha Christie's older sister. Madge lived in Cheadle with her husband James from 1902 until her death in 1950, and Abney Hall was one of their homes. After Christie was found in December 1926, Madge escorted her to Abney Hall to recover.

1902

Madge in Cheadle

1926

Agatha recovers at Abney



Detective photo challenge

Before you leave, find the strangest architectural detail you can see on Abney Hall: perhaps a gargoyle, an unusual chimney, a weather vane, an odd-shaped window or something else. Take your own photo. There is no correct answer.



SK8 SECRET TRAILS - CASE 001

THE CHEADLE CASE COMPLETED!

Team name: _____

Date completed: _____



CASE DEBRIEF

Help us improve the next SK8 Secret Trail

You have done the useful bit: tried the trail in the real world. A very short reply is enough. We mainly need to know what confused you, what changed on the ground, and whether you would do another one.

1. Children's ages

2. Approximate time taken

3. Which clue caused the most trouble or confusion?

4. Would you do another SK8 Secret Trail?

☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

5. Anything unsafe, blocked, hard to find or changed?



FASTEST WAY TO REPLY

Scan the code or email contact@sk8scoop.com

Subject: Cheadle Trail Feedback